



CVE-2025-20274: CISCO UNIFIED INTELLIGENCE CENTER ARBITRARY FILE UPLOAD VULNERABILITY

Vairav CVE Report

Date: July 17, 2025

Vairav Cyber Threat Intelligence Team

Vairav Technology Security Pvt. Ltd.

Thirbam Sadak 148

Baluwatar, Kathmandu

Phone: +977 4541540

Mobile: +977-9820105900

Email: sales@vairavtech.com

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A single vulnerability, **CVE-2025-20274**, has been discovered in Cisco Unified Intelligence Center's web-based management interface. The flaw allows any authenticated user with at least **Report Designer** privileges to upload arbitrary files. Successfully exploiting this vulnerability enables remote command execution on the underlying operating system and potential escalation to **root** privileges. The Cisco-assigned **CVSS v3.1 score is 6.3 (Medium)**.

VULNERABILITY DETAILS

CVE-2025-20274

- **Description:** Due to inadequate server-side validation, malicious files can be uploaded through the web management interface of Cisco Unified Intelligence Center. Authenticated attackers with at least Report Designer access can exploit this to place arbitrary files on the system, leading to OS-level command execution.
- **Impact:** Attackers can plant malicious scripts or binaries, execute arbitrary commands, and ultimately gain root privileges—fully compromising the server.
- **CVSS Score:** 6.3 (Medium)

AFFECTED VERSIONS

The following versions of Cisco Unified Intelligence Center Release are vulnerable:

- Cisco Unified Intelligence Center Release 12.5
- Cisco Unified Intelligence Center Release 12.6

EXPLOIT DETAILS

This vulnerability affects environments where Cisco Unified Intelligence Center is used for reporting services. An authenticated attacker with a **Report Designer** role can upload malicious files (e.g., shell scripts, binaries) via the interface. Once stored, these files can be executed on the OS layer—enabling privilege escalation to reign as root. No public proof-of-concept code has emerged yet, but pre-authentication is not required beyond possessing Report Designer credentials

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

Patch & Upgrade

- For Version 12.5: Upgrade to 12.5(1) SU ES05
- For Version 12.6: Upgrade to 12.6(2) ES05

ADDITIONAL SECURITY MEASURES

- Regularly review user access privileges to ensure least-privilege principles.
- Use Host IDS/IPS to flag and block abnormal process behaviors or OS-level commands emerging from the application environment.
- Conduct regular penetration testing on the management interface, especially focusing on file upload functionalities and privilege boundaries.

REFERENCES

- <https://sec.cloudapps.cisco.com/security/center/content/CiscoSecurityAdvisory/cisco-sa-cuis-file-upload-UhNEtStm>

CONTACT US

Vairav Technology Security Pvt. Ltd.

Cyber Defender from the land of Gurkha

Thirbam Sadak 148, Baluwatar

Kathmandu, Nepal

Phone: +977-01-4541540

Mobile: +977-9820105900

Email: sales@vairavtech.com

Website: <https://vairavtech.com>